

JSS 3 NIGERIAN HISTORY – FIRST TERM

TOPIC 6: NATIONAL SECURITY ISSUES

1. Insurgency

Insurgency refers to armed rebellion against the state. In Nigeria, groups such as Boko Haram and related factions have caused severe violence, especially in the North-East, with loss of life, displacement and disruption of education and livelihoods.

2. Banditry

Banditry involves armed groups that attack communities, kidnap for ransom and steal livestock, particularly in parts of the North-West and North-Central. It undermines farming, trade and safety.

3. Militancy

Militancy in the Niger Delta has been linked to resource control, environmental damage and criminal activity (e.g. oil theft). Government responses have included military action and amnesty programmes with mixed results.

4. Responses and Citizen Role

Security agencies, community cooperation, development and justice all matter. Citizens should report threats, avoid supporting criminal groups and promote peace. Lasting solutions combine security with opportunity and fairness.

5. Summary

Insurgency, banditry and militancy are major security challenges. Addressing them requires both firm security measures and long-term social and economic solutions.

End of Topic 6